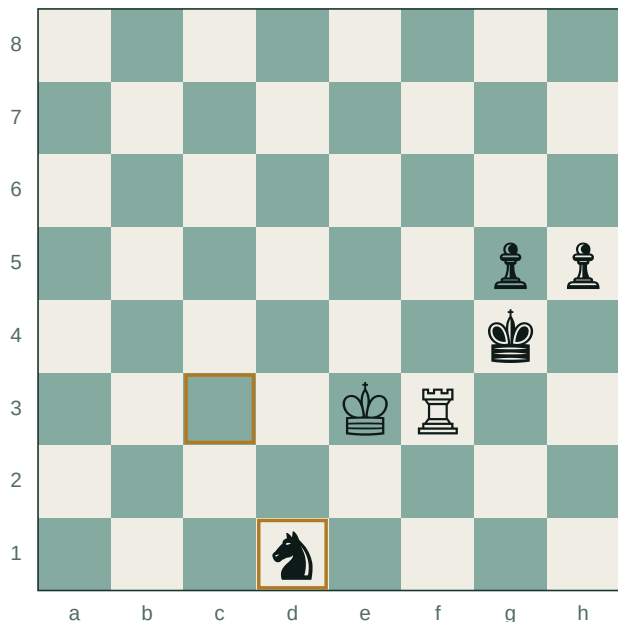


Clearance tactics: White, move 60

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 59...Nd1+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

60. Ke2 h4 61. Rd3 Nc3+ 62. Rxc3

60.Ke2 The king moves from e3 to e2. Recorded reply: **60...h4**.

61.Rd3 The rook moves from f3 to d3. Recorded reply: **61...Nc3+**.

62.Rxc3 The rook captures the knight on c3.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g4. Geometrically undefended: knight on d1. Check for tactical protection.